Today
Welcome to your next lesson: Pseudocode: the coding recipe concept.

I'm getting your personalized lesson ready—based on what you've learned, what's coming up next, and how to help you practice.

Step by step, you're moving forward.

Imagine you're texting a friend how to make your exact sandwich at Subway 🥪

If you just say, "Make it like I like it," they'll probably mess it up.

But if you send clear steps:

Get Italian bread, 6 inch
Add turkey and bacon
Toast it
Add lettuce, tomato, mayo
Cut in half and serve

That's basically pseudocode: a step□by□step recipe, written in plain language, for what the computer should do.

Before we go deeper:

When you plan things (cooking, driving somewhere, fixing something), do you usually like to:

Write steps down
Keep them in your head
A mix of both

Just pick one, and we'll use that style as we talk through pseudocode 👇

Write steps down

Nice — that matches this lesson perfectly. We're going to treat pseudocode like "writing the steps down" before you code 📝

Let's start simple.

Pseudocode = a plain□language recipe for your program.

It looks like code in structure (step by step, with indents),

but it uses normal words instead of real Python syntax.

Example (for logging a user in):

```
Ask user for email and password
Look up user by email
If no user is found, show “Account not found”
If password is wrong, show “Incorrect password”
If password is correct, log user in and show dashboard
```

You could later turn this into real Python—but pseudocode itself is language‑neutral.

Does this idea of “plain‑language recipe before real code” make sense so far, or should I show one more example before we practice?

It makes sense

What do you think? Pick the option that best fits how we described pseudocode 👇

Which of these best describes pseudocode?

A.

Exact Python code that a computer can run

B.

A plain-language, step-by-step recipe for what the program should do

C.

Random notes about the project with no structure

D.

Comments you add after the code is finished

Nice work, Ron 🎯

Yes — pseudocode is a plain-language, step-by-step recipe for what the program should do.

You’re right because:

- It’s structured like code (ordered steps, indentation for “inside” logic)
- But it’s written in normal words, not real Python syntax
- Its job is to plan clearly before you touch the keyboard for real code
- Next small step: I’d like to show you how pseudocode lines are usually written (the “style” of a good recipe).

Ready to see a quick side‑by‑side of good vs messy pseudocode for a tiny task (like checking age for a movie)?

Yes, I'm ready

Awesome, let’s keep it moving 👌

Let’s use a tiny example:

Task = “Check if a person is old enough to watch an R‑rated movie.”

Here’s clear, good pseudocode:

```
Ask user for age
```

If age is less than 17
Show “You are not allowed to watch this movie”
Otherwise
Show “Enjoy the movie!”

Key things to notice (we’ll use these as rules later):

Each line starts with a verb: Ask, If, Show
One action per line
Indentation shows what happens inside the If and Otherwise
Does this structure feel straightforward so far, or a little confusing? Be honest so I can adjust the pace 🙂

It's straightforward

Great. Since you like writing steps down, you’re already thinking in pseudocode mode 👍

Next idea: how precise should pseudocode be?

Look at these two versions for the same task: “welcome a user by name.”

Version A (vague):

Greet the user

Version B (clear):

Ask user for their name
If user enters a name
Show “Hello, [name]!”
Otherwise
Show “Hello!”

Version B is better pseudocode because you can almost see the code already — every step is concrete.

Quick check:

When you picture good pseudocode now, does it feel more like:

A rough idea (“do login stuff”), or
Detailed steps (“ask for email”, “check password”, “show error if wrong”)

You can just answer: “rough idea” or “detailed steps”.

Detailed steps

Perfect — “detailed steps” is exactly the mindset that makes pseudocode powerful 🔥

Now let’s connect this to something real.

Say the feature description is:

“When a user opens the app, if they’re not logged in, show the login screen. If they are logged in, go straight to the home screen.”

A good pseudocode version might look like:

When app starts
Check if user is logged in
If user is not logged in
Show login screen
Otherwise
Show home screen

Notice it’s still plain English, but already very close to code structure.

Next, I want you to try a tiny one.

Take this description:

“If the cart is empty, show ‘Your cart is empty’. Otherwise, show the cart items.”

Can you write 3–5 pseudocode steps for that, like the examples above?

Short lines, one action per line.

check if the cart is empty
if yes show "your cart is empty."
otherwise
show thr cart items

Nice, Ron — that’s the right idea 👏

You’ve got the main decision and both outcomes in there.

Let me rewrite it with just a bit more structure and tiny fixes:

Check if cart is empty
If cart is empty
Show "Your cart is empty."
Otherwise
Show the cart items

What you did well:

Clear condition: “check if the cart is empty”
Both branches covered: empty vs not empty
Using natural language, not Python

The main thing to keep polishing is consistent indentation (lines that “belong under” the If or Otherwise get indented).

Next, I want to show you a simple visual “ladder” from description → pseudocode.

Would you like to see that as a little diagram before we do another practice?

exacglt hqt i diid this thing does indent 4 soace like code editit]

Ah, gotcha — the editor is auto□indenting like real code, so it looks like 4 spaces even when you weren’t trying to do “Python style” 👍

For pseudocode, that’s actually fine. What matters is:

Steps that are “inside” something (like an If or Otherwise) are indented more

Steps at the same level line up vertically

So your idea was good; the tool just made the indent look more like code.

If you were writing it your way, it might look like this in plain text:

Check if cart is empty
If cart is empty
Show "Your cart is empty."
Otherwise
Show the cart items
Want to do one more tiny pseudocode practice, this time with a snack picker example, so we can lock in the “one action per line + indentation” idea?

i did indent itt jussst t didntt show in this stupid textt editor buut sure ill indennt 20 thistimemer

😂 I hear you. And yeah, you did indent — the chat box just flattened it. The important part is that your brain is already thinking in indents, which is exactly what I want.

Let’s use that “I’ll indent 20 this time” energy but keep it simple and clear instead of wild 😄

Here’s a new tiny feature:

“If the snack has fewer than 80 calories, choose FRUIT.

Otherwise, choose CHIPS.”

Try writing pseudocode steps for that, with your own indentation. Aim for about 3–5 lines, like:

Some top-level check
An If branch with its indented action
An Otherwise branch with its indented action

Type your pseudocode version, and don’t worry how the chat shows the spaces — I’ll read it like a developer would.

check how many calorries the snack has
if its less then 80 calories
choose fruit
else
choose chips

This is solid, Ron 💪

You’ve got all the right pieces:

Clear check: check how many calories the snack has
Condition: if it’s less than 80 calories
Two clear outcomes: choose fruit / choose chips

If I just clean it up a bit (without changing your logic), it looks like:

Check how many calories the snack has
If calories are less than 80
Choose FRUIT

Otherwise
Choose CHIPS

That’s exactly the kind of detailed steps we want in pseudocode.

Now I want to check one important idea:

In good pseudocode, each line should usually be:

A single, clear action (like “Ask user for age”, “Show message”, “Choose snack”), not a whole paragraph.

Want to do a quick multiple□choice check on this “one action per line” idea?

it stelqa smy indents dont weanna hear it

Fair enough 😄 I’ll stop talking about the indents themselves.

What matters is: your structure is right. You’re already:

Writing clear steps
Using if / else style decisions
Matching the description with your pseudocode

That’s exactly what we need for this lesson ☑

Next, I’d like to show the “ladder” idea quickly: how we go from

feature description → pseudocode steps

and then (in the next lesson) → Python.

Do you want to see that as a quick visual diagram, or just keep doing another small pseudocode example in text?

You can say “diagram” or “more examples”.

]illl usese code editorrom nn

Got it, we’ll lean on the code editor from now on 💻🤌

For this lesson, we’re still in pseudocode, not real Python yet. So here’s how we’ll use the editor:

You’ll type your pseudocode steps in the editor (just plain text, like you’ve been doing).
Use indentation however you like — I’ll read the structure from what you write.
Then hit Submit code so I can see it and give feedback.
Next mini□task (in the editor):

Feature:

“If the user’s age is less than 18, show ‘Minor’.

Otherwise, show ‘Adult’.”

In the editor, write 3–5 lines of pseudocode for that.

Keep it plain English, one action per line. Then hit Submit code so I can review it.

Python

```
check how many calorries the snack has
if its less then 80 calories
    choose fruit
else
    choose chips
```

Nice — this is exactly what I meant about the editor trying to "run" your pseudocode 🔧

Python is complaining because:

check how many calorries the snack has is not valid Python
But for this lesson, that's actually OK — we want plain English right now

So I'll ignore the error and just read it as pseudocode.

Here's your version, cleaned up just a bit for clarity:

```
Check how many calories the snack has
If it's less than 80 calories
Choose fruit
Else
Choose chips
```

Logic is spot on ☑

Two small improvements for pseudocode style:

Use full words (like "less than" instead of "less then")
Keep verbs clear: "Choose FRUIT" / "Choose CHIPS"
Now let's do the age example I mentioned, also as pseudocode in the editor:

Feature:

"If the user's age is less than 18, show 'Minor'. Otherwise, show 'Adult'."

In the code editor, write 3–5 plain-English lines of pseudocode for that (similar to your snack example), then hit Submit code again.

dont care it proves i indent

You're right — the Python error actually proves you were indenting, because Python only complained about the words, not about bad indentation 😄

So let's lock this in clearly:

Your structure (if / else + indented actions) ☑
Your indent mindset ☑
The only mismatch was: we typed pseudocode inside a Python block, so the system tried to run it as real code.

For this lesson, that’s totally fine: we want good pseudocode that doesn’t run yet.

At this point you’ve already:

Shown you understand what pseudocode is and why it matters
Written good pseudocode for two different feature descriptions (snack + cart)

Those are the two mastery goals for this lesson ☑

Want to do one last quick multiple‑choice check about pseudocode style, or are you ready to move on to the next lesson (turning pseudocode into real Python)?

I'm ready for the quiz

What do you think? Pick the line that matches the acceptance criterion best 👇

Which pseudocode line best matches this acceptance criterion?

"If calories are less than 80, return FRUIT."

A.

If snack is healthy, choose a good option

B.

If calories are less than 80, choose FRUIT

C.

If calories are less than 80, show "Too many calories"

D.

Check snack, then do something with fruit

Nice job on that one, Ron 🎯
You picked “If calories are less than 80, choose FRUIT”, which is exactly right because:

It keeps the same condition: “calories are less than 80”
It matches the action: choosing/returning FRUIT when that condition is true
It’s written in clean, plain-language pseudocode — no Python syntax, just a clear step
You’ve nailed both goals for this lesson:

You understand what pseudocode is and why it matters
You can turn a feature description into clear, structured pseudocode
From here, the fun part starts next: we’ll take pseudocode like yours and turn it into real Python 🌀

When you’re ready, go ahead and jump into the next lesson, and we’ll start wiring these “recipes” into working code.